MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps-Focused QA Automation Engineer | CI/CD, Test Infrastructure & DevOps

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

DevOps-focused QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including a strong focus over the last two years on CI/CD pipelines, Kubernetes-based test environments and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines and supports test infrastructure for three product teams. Experienced in improving pipeline speed and reliability, and in documenting technical workflows for team onboarding. Building infrastructure-as-code and platform skills through personal projects, including a k3s homelab with GitOps and Terraform-provisioned Hetzner infrastructure.

EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by profiling pipelines, parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs decreased by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request test environments (application, PostgreSQL and seeded data) using Docker Compose and later Helm on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster; environments are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Enable QA and product teams to review features before merge, with end-to-end tests running against the ephemeral environments.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of about 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and created Grafana dashboards to help teams identify flaky tests.
- Write Bash and Python tooling for test-data seeding into PostgreSQL.
- Authored an internal guide to how the CI system works, used in team onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated approaches.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

AWS Learning

- Used the AWS free tier for learning, including EC2 and S3 basics.

EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology *2018*

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level *2019*

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) *Studying; exam booked for January 2027*

SKILLS

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access; test environments), k3s, Terraform (personal projects), Argo CD

Monitoring & Data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL

Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

Languages & Tools: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, Linux, Git, Ansible (basic)

Cloud: AWS (learning; EC2 and S3 basics)

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)